



METU Alumni Deutschland i.Gr.

Berliner Allee 59 40212 Düsseldorf

Privacy Notice on the Protection of Personal Data for Membership Applications and Association Membership

Version 1.0 | 28 September 2026

1. Data Controller

Pursuant to the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR / DSGVO), the data controller is:

METU Alumni Deutschland i. Gr.

Berliner Allee 59, 40212 Düsseldorf

E-mail: info@odtum.de

2. Collection and Processing of Personal Data

As part of your membership application, we collect and process the following personal data:

- Basic Information: Surname, first name, date of birth
- Contact Information: Home address (street, house number, postal code, city), email address, telephone number (optional)
- Academic Credentials and Residency Status: METU (ODTÜ) department, degree obtained, year of graduation, and a copy of the diploma/graduation certificate submitted by you
- Optional Information: Professional activity (title/position) and work address
- Membership Fee Discount Status: Whether the applicant is a student or not. Students may be required to provide a valid student certificate as supporting documentation.
- Payment Data: Account holder's name, address, bank name, IBAN and BIC (for the SEPA Direct Debit Mandate)

Providing your data is voluntary. However, all data not marked as optional is required to admit you and to administer your membership; without it, we cannot process your application.

3. Purposes and Legal Bases for Processing

Your data will be processed solely for the following purposes:

- Establishment and Administration of Membership: For the proper maintenance of the membership register, communication with you, and the fulfillment of our duties under the association's statutes (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR – performance of the membership contract).
- Verification of Membership Requirements: The supporting documents provided (e.g., copy of diploma) are processed to verify whether you meet the membership requirements specified in the association's statutes (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR – steps taken at your request before membership).
- Compliance with Legal Obligations: To comply with statutory retention obligations under tax and association law (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(c) GDPR).
- Determination of Membership Fee: The information provided regarding student is processed to determine eligibility for any applicable membership fee discount. Where required, supporting documents such as a valid student certificate may be requested (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR – performance of the membership contract).
- Collection of Membership Fees: For the collection of the annual membership fee via SEPA Direct Debit (Legal basis: Article 6(1)(b) GDPR).

4. Disclosure of Data to Third Parties

Your personal data is disclosed only to: service providers who process it on our behalf under a data processing agreement (Article 28 GDPR), in particular our membership management software (easyVerein) and our email provider; our bank, to which your account details are transmitted to collect membership fees; and public authorities, where we are legally obliged to disclose it.

5. Retention Period and Deletion of Data

- Member Data: Your general personal data will be retained for the duration of your active membership. After your membership ends, your data will be deleted unless there is a legal obligation requiring its retention (for example, the statutory ten-year retention period applicable to tax-related documents and

- banking transactions pursuant to Section 147 of the German Fiscal Code (AO)).
- Academic Documents (Diplomas/Supporting Documents): Copies of submitted diplomas will be permanently deleted after verification and membership approval. Only confirmation of successful verification will be retained.
- Student Certificates: Any student certificate submitted for the purpose of obtaining a membership fee discount will be deleted after verification, unless a legal retention obligation applies.

6. Your Rights

Under the GDPR, you have the right to obtain information about the personal data stored about you (Article 15), the right to rectification (Article 16), the right to erasure (Article 17), the right to restriction of processing (Article 18), the right to data portability (Article 20), and the right to object (Article 21). You also have the right to lodge a complaint with a competent data protection supervisory authority.